

Vivo V29e

Slim on size, not on your pocket!

The Vivo V29e is the youngest of the lot. This is the device that will sit at the bottom of the V-lineup, below the Vivo V29 and the Vivo V29 Pro, both of which are expected to arrive in October this year. Now, while it sits at the bottom of the pyramid, the Vivo V29e also targets the mid-range segment between the ₹25,000 to ₹30,000 price band. But apart from the premium look and feel, does the smartphone justify this price? Let's find out:

DESIGN

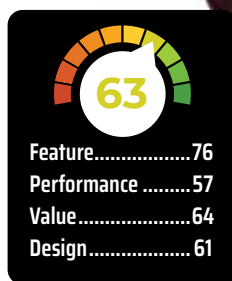
The Vivo V29e is a beautiful phone. It looks premium, it feels nice and light in the hands, it is slim. We get a curved front and back, with this sort of dual-tone back where we also get a glossy patterned stripe running through the left side of the back panel. The smartphone is also super lightweight and very slim, making it super handy and very easy to hold and use with one hand.

There is a hole-punch curved display with the camera cutout in the middle of the screen.

Overall, it is a slightly new implementation to a familiar design that we have come to know the Vivo V-series smartphones to be in the last couple of years. We get the familiar curved back and front, along with a super slim and light profile with a hint of change with the back panel and the new camera implementation.

DISPLAY

The display on the Vivo V29e is a 6.78-inch 10-bit curved AMOLED panel with a 120Hz refresh rate and an FHD+ resolution (1260x2800p) with support for HDR10+. The display is good. The first time you set eyes on this display, it is a pleasant and smooth experience. It is nicely sharp and detailed, and the colour representation is also pretty good.



The smartphone's display has three colour profiles – Standard, Bright, and Pro. Here, the Pro is the one that is the

most colour accurate (sRGB), while the other two, standard and bright are towards the saturated side, with the Standard profile being the DCI-P3 profile, and the Bright one being the saturated colour tone that is only there to make the display appear more vibrant.

I tested the colour accuracy on the most colour accurate "Pro" colour profile on the Vivo V29e, and the smartphone passed with flying colours! In the sRGB colour checker analysis, the Vivo V29e showed an average DeltaE of 2.4, which means that the Vivo V29e's display represents colours very close to their original. For any display, an average DeltaE of under 3 is considered very good.

In the grayscale test, the Vivo V29e followed Gamma 2.4 quite evenly, but smartphone displays are more tuned towards Gamma 2.2, since Gamma 2.4 is more tuned towards viewing content in darker spaces. Apart from that, the Vivo V29e showed a good RGB balance during the grayscale test. Coming to brightness, the Vivo V29e has quite a

bright panel on offer. The smartphone showed a maximum luminance of 842 when I tested the brightness using a Lux Meter. Now, the numbers are pretty good, but the sunlight visibility of the Vivo V29e isn't very good. At times, it felt like the smartphone is lacking that vibrancy that makes it stand out in the brightest of environments.

Overall, it is a very good display. It is accurate, it is responsive, and it is vibrant in the colour profiles meant to make the display stand out. The sunlight visibility isn't the best we have seen, but that isn't a deal breaker. What could be one though, is that the Vivo V29e doesn't support HDR content on YouTube.

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, this is the biggest chink in Vivo's V-series' armour.

Year after year, the Vivo V-series smartphones have praised with their premium look and feel, but the performance is something Vivo only recently fixed with the V27 Pro. The Vivo V29e, sadly, doesn't take that trend forward.

For a Rs 27,000 pricetag, the Vivo V29e only offers a Qualcomm Snapdragon 695, making it probably the second-most expensive smartphone to come with the Snapdragon 695 chip. This budget chipset from Qualcomm is usually seen in smartphones around the Rs 20,000 range.

As usual, I ran a bunch of benchmarks, and my first brush with just how low the price-to-performance ratio is, was when the smartphone wasn't able to run AnTuTu and I had to download AnTuTu Lite in order for the benchmark to run on the Vivo V29e. It is a bit of a shame for a Rs 27,000 smartphone to not be able to run one of the most common benchmarks. The score, as expected, wasn't the best in its segment. The Vivo V29e scored 453,640 points in AnTuTu, which is about half of what some of the competing devices were able to put out.

On other benchmarks also, the Vivo V29e lagged way behind competition, putting out a single core score of 910 points in Geekbench Single Core test and a score of 2170 points in the Geekbench Multi-Core score.